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Multifunctional fishing rod holder

Abstract

A multifunctional fishing rod holder is a device that improves the chances of attracting fish and indicates when a fish has bitten the lure. The device includes a holder base, a flexible arm, a rod-holding assembly, a sail shaft, and an indicator sail. The holder base positions the desired fishing rod next to the ice hole in any terrain. The flexible arm supports the desired fishing rod in an elevated position next to the ice hole. The rod-holding assembly secures the desired fishing rod to the flexible arm. The sail shaft securely attaches the indicator sail to the flexible arm without obstructing the attachment of the desired fishing rod to the flexible arm. The indicator sail visually indicates when a fish has bitten the lure. The indicator sail also enables the light movement of the flexible arm to move the attached fishing rod as wind impacts the indicator sail.

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Background/Summary

(1) The current application claims a priority to the U.S. provisional patent application Ser. No. 63/590,545 filed on Oct. 16, 2023.

FIELD OF THE INVENTION

(1) The present invention generally relates to fishing equipment. More specifically, the present invention discloses a multifunctional fishing rod holder that signals when a bite has occurred, vertically supports the fishing rod to prevent tangles, and prevents wind-driven snow from interfering with the triggering action.

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

(2) Ice fishing is the practice of catching fish with lines and fishhooks or spears through an opening in the ice on a frozen body of water. Ice fishing is challenging at times since trudging through deep snow on foot is hard work. Also, fish can concentrate in certain areas in winter and, as such, finding the fish may be difficult. Hence, the setup process can be long and is further complicated due to the cold weather conditions. In addition, even after the setup process is complete, waiting for the fish to bite can be difficult task. Holding a fishing rod and waiting for the fish to bite can be especially arduous in cold weather, even while wearing the proper gear. Some fishing equipment has been made available to help people safely fish in these conditions, such as ice fishing rod holders. In general, these rod holders are designed to support the fishing rod on the ice next to the ice hole so that the user does not need to hold the fishing rod while waiting for the fish to bite. However, these rod holders have many limitations that impact the effectiveness in properly catching fish.

(3) The currently available ice fishing rod holders often lack the structural strength to maintain the fishing rod next to the ice hole in the proper position. Due to the weather conditions, the fishing rod can move and get loose which may cause several problems, such as the fishing line getting tangled. Further, most of the available fishing rod holders do not have the means to indicate to the user when the fish has bitten. The user often must rely on visual cues, such as watching the fishing rod move, to determine that the fish has bitten. This can be harder to do in harsh weather conditions, such as during low light conditions. Thus, a self-standing fishing rod holder for ice fishing that can support the fishing rod in place above the ground while waiting for the fish to bite, prevent tangles on the fishing line due to wind conditions, as well as indicate the user when a bite has occurred is necessary.

(4) An objective of the present invention is to provide a multifunctional fishing rod holder that signals when a bite has occurred. The present invention is preferably designed for ice fishing to support the rod, reel, and other mechanical parts of the fishing rod above ice and snow to prevent tangles on the fishing line. Another objective of the present invention is to provide a collapsible base structure with gripping features that enables the present invention to be set up in various terrains. Further, another objective of the present invention is to provide an alarm mechanism that is triggered when the fish bites but does not obstruct the movement of the fishing line.

Furthermore, another objective of the present invention is to provide a fishing rod holder that

facilitates the removal of the fishing rod once the fish bites. Additional features and benefits of the present invention are further discussed in the sections below.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

(5) The present invention discloses a multifunctional fishing rod holder that signals when a bite has occurred, supports the rod, reel, and other mechanical parts of the fishing rod above ice and snow, and prevents tangles on the fishing line. To accomplish this, the present invention includes a collapsible base structure with gripping features that enables to set up the device in various terrains. Further, the present invention includes means to indicate to the user when a fish has bitten the bait. This can include, but is not limited to, a visual mechanism, such as a sail, that acts as a visual indicator, and an audio alarm that emits a sound alarm when the fish has bitten the bait. Furthermore, the present invention includes a sturdy mechanism that holds the fishing rod in place while also facilitating the removal of the fishing rod from the present invention once the fish has bitten the bait. Additional features can be implemented that further improve the functionality of the present invention.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) FIG. 1 is a top-front-right perspective view of the present invention, wherein the holder base is shown in the rod-holding configuration to hold a desired fishing rod, and wherein the electronic alarm and the trigger mechanism is shown in an alarm-primed configuration.
- (2) FIG. 2 is a right-side view of the present invention thereof.
- (3) FIG. 3 is a right-side view of the present invention, wherein the electronic alarm and the trigger mechanism is shown in alarm-activated configuration.
- (4) FIG. 4 is a right-side view of the present invention thereof, wherein the sail shaft is shown deployed along with the indicator sail, and wherein the electronic alarm is shown emitting a sound alert.
- (5) FIG. 5 is a top-front-right perspective view of the present invention, wherein the holder base is shown in the rod-holding configuration, and wherein the present invention is shown without the desired fishing rod.
- (6) FIG. 6 is a top-rear-left perspective view of the present invention thereof.
- (7) FIG. 7 is a top-front-right perspective view of the present invention, wherein the holder base is shown in a storage configuration.
- (8) FIG. 8 is a top-rear-left perspective view of the present invention thereof.
- (9) FIG. 9 is a bottom-rear-right perspective view of the present invention thereof.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF THE INVENTION

- (10) All illustrations of the drawings are for the purpose of describing selected versions of the present invention and are not intended to limit the scope of the present invention.
- (11) The present invention discloses a multifunctional fishing rod holder that improves the chances of attracting fish and indicates when a fish has bitten the lure. As can be seen in FIGS. 1 through 9, the present invention comprises a holder base **1**, a flexible arm **10**, a rod-holding assembly **13**, a sail shaft **18**, and an indicator sail **21**. The holder base **1** is designed to position the desired fishing rod next to the ice hole in any terrain. The flexible arm **10** supports the desired fishing rod in an elevated position next to the ice hole. The rod-holding assembly **13** secures the desired fishing rod to the flexible arm **10** in such a way that the desired fishing rod can be easily removed. The sail shaft **18** enables the secure attachment of the indicator sail **21** to the flexible arm **10** without obstructing the attachment of the desired fishing rod to the flexible arm **10**. The indicator sail **21** serves to visually indicate when a fish has bitten the lure. The indicator sail **21** also enables the light movement of the flexible arm **10** to move the attached fishing rod as wind impacts the

indicator sail **21**.

(12) The overall arrangement of the aforementioned components enables the user to have a better experience ice fishing. As can be seen in FIGS. **1** through **9**, the holder base **1** is designed as a foldable and portable structure that can be set up in any terrain as desired. To do so, the holder base **1** comprises a 4-way tee fitting **2**, a static leg **7**, a first dynamic leg **8**, and a second dynamic leg **9**. The 4-way tee fitting **2** enables the secure assembly of the holder base **1** to form a foldable and portable structure. The static leg **7**, the first dynamic leg **8**, the second dynamic leg **9**, and the static leg **7** serve to form a stable support that can be folded to facilitate storage and transportability. Further, the flexible arm **10** corresponds to an elongated sturdy structure that can bend to position the desired fishing rod at the appropriate orientation to attract the fish. So, the flexible arm **10** comprises a proximal arm end **11** and a distal arm end **12** corresponding to the opposite terminal ends of the flexible arm **10**. Similarly, the sail shaft **18** is an elongated sturdy structure that supports the indicator sail **21** in such a way that the indicator sail **21** can engage the wind flow. So, the sail shaft **18** comprises a spring-loaded shaft end **19** and a free shaft end **20** corresponding to the terminal ends of the sail shaft **18**.

(13) In the preferred embodiment, the present invention can be arranged as follows: the rod-holding assembly **13** is mounted onto the distal arm end **12** to secure the rod-holding assembly **13** to the flexible arm **10**, as can be seen in FIGS. **1** through **9**. On the other hand, the 4-way tee fitting **2** is mounted onto the proximal arm end **11** to secure the flexible arm **10** to the 4-way tee fitting **2**. This way, the rod-holding assembly **13** is positioned as far as possible from the 4-way tee fitting **2** so that when the desired fishing rod is mounted onto the rod-holding assembly **13**, the desired fishing rod is kept elevated from the ground. Further, the flexible arm **10**, the static leg **7**, and the first dynamic leg **8** are orthogonally mounted to each other by the 4-way tee fitting **2** to form an overall pyramid structure that provides lateral support to the flexible arm **10** when set up. Likewise, the flexible arm **10**, the static leg **7**, and the second dynamic leg **9** are orthogonally mounted to each other by the 4-way tee fitting **2** to also form an overall pyramid structure that provides lateral support to the flexible arm **10** when set up. Thus, the flexible arm **10** can only flex in the direction aligned with the static leg **7** when holding the desired fishing line.

(14) As can be seen in FIGS. **1** through **9**, the flexible arm **10** is arranged so that the rod-holding assembly **13** is oriented towards the static leg **7**. This way, when the desired fishing rod is mounted onto the rod-holding assembly **13**, the flexible arm **10** flexes towards the static leg **7** without the desired fishing rod touching the ground. Further, the spring-loaded shaft end **19** is laterally connected to the flexible arm **10**, offset from the rod-holding assembly **13**, so that the sail shaft **18** is connected to the flexible arm **10**. The spring-loaded shaft end **19** allows the sail shaft **18** to move when the wind flow hits the indicator sail **21**. In addition, the sail shaft **18** is oriented away from the static leg **7** so that neither the sail shaft **18** nor the indicator sail **21** does not obstruct the desired fishing rod. Furthermore, the indicator sail **21** is mounted onto the free shaft end **20** to secure the indicator sail **21** to the sail shaft **18**. In the preferred embodiment, the indicator sail **21** is large enough to engage the wind flow without weighting down the flexible arm **10** to prevent the desired fishing rod from touching the ground. In addition, the indicator sail **21** is designed so that the indicator sail **21** can be visible in different weather conditions. In other embodiments, the present invention can be arranged to support other fishing equipment along with the desired fishing rod.

(15) As previously discussed, the holder base **1** is designed as a foldable structure that facilitates the transportation and storage of the device. As can be seen in FIGS. **1** through **9**, the 4-way tee fitting **2** comprises a first C-shaped socket **3**, a second C-shaped socket **4**, a third C-shaped socket **5**, and a round socket **6**. The first C-shaped socket **3**, the second C-shaped socket **4**, and the third C-shaped socket **5** enable the dynamic legs to be manually folded by the user, while the round socket **6** maintains the static leg **7** in a fixed position. So, the round socket **6**, the first C-shaped socket **3**, and the second C-shaped socket **4** are positioned coplanar to each other to form an overall straight base structure for the present invention. The first C-shaped socket **3** and the second C-shaped

socket **4** are positioned opposite to each other about the 4-way tee fitting **2** to receive the first dynamic leg **8** and the second dynamic leg **9**, respectively. The first C-shaped socket **3** and the second C-shaped socket **4** are also positioned perpendicular to the round socket **6** due to the 4-way tee fitting **2** structure design.

(16) In addition, the third C-shaped socket **5** is oriented geometrically normal to the round socket **6**, the first C-shaped socket **3**, and the second C-shaped socket **4** to complete the 4-way tee fitting **2**, as can be seen in FIGS. **1** through **9**. Further, the static leg **7** is mounted into the round socket **6** to secure the static leg **7** to the 4-way tee fitting **2**, which keeps the static leg **7** in a fixed position relative to the 4-way tee fitting **2**. On the other hand, the first dynamic leg **8** is hingedly connected into the first C-shaped socket **3** to secure the first dynamic leg **8** to the 4-way tee fitting **2**.

Likewise, the second dynamic leg **9** is also hingedly connected into the second C-shaped socket **4** to secure the second dynamic leg **9** to the 4-way tee fitting **2**. Thus, the first dynamic leg **8** and the second dynamic leg **9** can be folded towards the static leg **7** as desired by the user. Furthermore, the flexible arm **10** is also hingedly connected into the third C-shaped socket **5**, which allows the flexible arm **10** to also be folded towards the static leg **7** when desired by the user for storage and transportability.

(17) As previously discussed, the foldable design of the holder base **1** allows the user to set the present invention into different configurations. As can be seen in FIGS. **1** through **6**, in a rod-holding configuration, the flexible arm **10**, the static leg **7**, the first dynamic leg **8**, and the second dynamic leg **9** are arranged to support the desired fishing rod. In addition, due to the additional load from the desired fishing rod on the flexible arm **10**, the present invention may further comprise a locking sleeve **22** that prevents the flexible arm **10** from folding down accidentally. The locking sleeve **22** is preferably a tubular hollow device that can be selectively engaged with the third C-shaped socket **5** to ensure that the flexible arm **10** stays in the upright position when holding the desired fishing rod. So, in the rod-holding configuration, the first dynamic leg **8** and the second dynamic leg **9** are positioned perpendicular to the static leg **7**. In addition, the first dynamic leg **8** and the second dynamic leg **9** are positioned colinear to each other to form a triangular structure to support the desired fishing rod. Further, the flexible arm **10** is oriented geometrically normal to the static leg **7**, the first dynamic leg **8**, and the second dynamic leg **9** to orient the flexible arm **10** upwards. This way, the rod-holding assembly **13** is elevated to receive the desired fishing rod. Furthermore, the locking sleeve **22** is laterally positioned around the hinged connection between the flexible arm **10** and the second C-shaped socket **4** to prevent the flexible arm **10** from folding down once the desired fishing rod is attached to the rod-holding assembly **13**.

(18) Alternatively, the present invention can be arranged for storage and transportability. As can be seen in FIGS. **7** through **9**, in the storage configuration, the flexible arm **10**, the static leg **7**, the first dynamic leg **8**, and the second dynamic leg **9** are arranged so that the overall assembly takes less space and can be more easily carried by the user. To do so, the first dynamic leg **8**, the second dynamic leg **9**, and the flexible arm **10** are positioned parallel to the static leg **7**. Once the desired fishing rod is removed from the rod-holding assembly **13**, the locking sleeve **22** can be decoupled from the third C-shaped socket **5** to free the flexible arm **10**. Then, the user can fold the flexible arm **10** down to position the flexible arm **10** against the static leg **7**. Similarly, the first dynamic leg **8** and the second dynamic leg **9** can be moved towards static leg **7**. Thus, the holder base **1** can be arranged to raise the moving parts up and out of the snow and ice yet can also be collapsed into a self-contained unit. In other embodiments, different configurations can be implemented to facilitate other functions of the present invention to accommodate other fishing equipment.

(19) As previously discussed, the present invention is designed to be utilized in different weather conditions and terrain. As can be seen in FIGS. **1** through **9**, to enable the present invention to be securely utilized in different terrain, the present invention may further comprise a plurality of stakes **23**. The plurality of stakes **23** enables the holder base **1** to be secured to the ground when supporting the desired fishing rod. To do so, the plurality of stakes **23** is connected onto the holder

base **1** to integrate the plurality of stakes **23** on the holder base **1**. Further, each of the plurality of stakes **23** is oriented away from the flexible arm **10** so that each stake is driven into the ground once the holder base **1** is placed in the desired location to support the desired fishing rod.

(20) As can be seen in FIGS. **1** through **9**, the plurality of stakes **23** is preferably arranged to provide the maximum support to the holder base **1**. In the preferred embodiment, the plurality of stakes **23** includes several stakes that are evenly distributed throughout the holder base **1**. So, the plurality of stakes **23** comprises a first stake **24**, a second stake **25**, and a third stake **26**. The first stake **24** is laterally connected to the first dynamic leg **8**, offset from the 4-way tee fitting **2**, to secure the first stake **24** to the free end of the first dynamic leg **8**. Similarly, the second stake **25** is laterally connected to the second dynamic leg **9**, offset from the 4-way tee fitting **2**, to secure the second stake **25** to the free end of the second dynamic leg **9**. Furthermore, the third stake **26** is laterally connected to the static leg **7**, offset from the 4-way tee fitting **2**, to also secure the third stake **26** to the static leg **7**. Thus, the plurality of stakes **23** is evenly distributed to secure the holder base **1** to the ground.

(21) As previously discussed, the rod-holding assembly **13** is designed to securely retain the desired fishing rod. As can be seen in FIGS. **1** through **9**, the rod-holding assembly **13** may comprise a grip holder **14** and a grip brace **16**. The grip holder **14** is designed to retain the handle portion of the desired fishing rod while the grip brace **16** is designed to retain the butt portion. Further, the grip holder **14** comprises a gripping surface **15** and the grip brace **16** comprises a bracing surface **17**. The gripping surface **15** is a quick-release mechanism that secures the handle portion of the desired fishing rod to the grip holder **14**. For example, the gripping surface **15** can be a flexible band with several integrated gripping features that engage the outer surfaces of the handle portion of the desired fishing rod. When the handle portion is engaged into the grip holder **14**, the handle portion is surrounded by the gripping surface **15** to secure the handle portion within the grip holder **14**. The grip strength is strong enough to keep the desired fishing rod attached to the grip holder **14** while waiting for the fish to bite, even under harsh weather conditions. However, the user can apply a greater force by moving the rod-holding assembly **13** and the handle portion away from each other to release the desired fishing rod. Further, the bracing surface **17** secures the butt portion in place to prevent the desired fishing rod from moving sideways while attached to the rod-holding assembly **13**. The bracing surface **17** is an arc-shaped structure that matches the shape and size of the butt portion to engage the butt portion without completely restraining the butt portion. Thus, the desired fishing rod can be easily attached to the rod-holding assembly **13** without the use of external tools. Similarly, the desired fishing rod can be easily removed from the rod-holding assembly **13** once the fish has bitten the lure.

(22) In the preferred embodiment, the rod-holding assembly **13** can be arranged as follows: the grip holder **14** and the grip brace **16** are laterally connected to the flexible arm **10** to secure the grip holder **14** and the grip brace **16** to the flexible arm **10**, as can be seen in FIGS. **1** through **9**. Both the grip holder **14** and the grip brace **16** can be directly connected to the flexible arm **10**, or an intermediate structure can be implemented to secure the rod-holding assembly **13** to the flexible arm **10**. Further, the grip holder **14** and the grip brace **16** are positioned collinear to each other along the flexible arm **10** so that the handle portion and the butt portion of the desired fishing rod can be simultaneously attached to both the grip holder **14** and the grip brace **16**, respectively. The grip holder **14** and the grip brace **16** are also oriented towards the static leg **7** so that when the desired fishing rod is attached, the weight of the desired fishing rod bends the flexible arm **10** towards the static leg **7**. Further, the grip holder **14** is positioned in between the distal arm end **12** and the grip brace **16** so that the attached fishing rod maintains the fishing line oriented towards the water. The gripping surface **15** and the bracing surface **17** are also positioned parallel to each other to maintain the attached fishing rod aligned towards the water. In other embodiments, different mechanisms can be utilized to retain the desired fishing rod in a quick release manner.

(23) As previously discussed, the present invention includes means to alert the user when a fish has

bitten the lure. In addition to the indicator sail **21**, the present invention may further comprise an electronic alarm **27** and a trigger mechanism **28**, as can be seen in FIGS. **1** through **9**. The electronic alarm **27** is designed to emit an audible alert for the user in addition to the visual indication from the indicator sail **21**. The trigger mechanism **28** enables the automatic activation of the electronic alarm **27** when the fish has bitten. The trigger mechanism **28** is preferably a mechanical system that allows the simultaneous activation of the indicator sail **21** and the electronic alarm **27** once the fish has bitten. To do so, the trigger mechanism **28** comprises a hook **29**, a catch **30**, a yoke **31**, a setting **32**, and an axle **33**. The hook **29** is designed to releasably retain the sail shaft **18** against flexible arm **10** when the desired fishing rod is set to lure the fish. The catch **30** facilitates the releasable connection between the hook **29** and the sail shaft **18**. The yoke **31** engages the fishing line of the desired fishing rod without obstructing the movement of the fishing line. In addition, the yoke **31** enables the automatic activation of the electronic alarm **27** when the fishing line is pulled by the caught fish. Further, the setting **32** and the axle **33** enable the simultaneous movement of the hook **29** and the yoke **31** to simultaneously activate the electronic alarm **27** and the indicator sail **21**.

(24) In the preferred embodiment, the electronic alarm **27** and the trigger mechanism **28** can be implemented as follows: the setting **32** and the electronic alarm **27** are laterally mounted to the flexible arm **10**, adjacent to the distal arm end **12**, to secure the setting **32** and the electronic alarm **27** to the flexible arm **10**, as can be seen in FIGS. **1** through **9**. The setting **32** is preferably a brace-like structure that retains the axle **33** in such a way that the axle **33** can rotate within the setting **32**. Further, the hook **29** is terminally connected to the axle **33** to secure the hook **29** to the axle **33** and form a single structure. Similarly, the yoke **31** is also terminally connected to the axle **33**, opposite to the hook **29**, to secure the yoke **31** to the axle **33** and form a single structure with the hook **29**. For example the hook **29**, the axle **33**, and the yoke **31** can be a single structure formed from sturdy wire with the hook **29** and the yoke **31** being oriented parallel to each other.

(25) As can be seen in FIGS. **1** through **9**, the axle **33** is further rotatably mounted through the setting **32** in such a way that the axle **33** can freely rotate within the setting **32**. This way, when the yoke **31** is moved by the fishing line when the fish is caught, the hook **29** is also moved as the axle **33** transmits the torque from the yoke **31** to the hook **29**. Moreover, the catch **30** is laterally mounted to the sail shaft **18**, offset from the free shaft end **20**, so that the catch **30** can move along the sail shaft **18**. This allows the indicator sail **21** to move along with the wind flow around the indicator sail **21**. In addition, the flexible arm **10** is preferably a tempered spring steel strap which allows the flexible arm **10** to flex without collapsing. As a result, the sail shaft **18** and flexible arm **10** move as a well in a rocking motion that moves the attached fishing rod to further attract the desired fish without the fishing rod hitting the ground. The flexible arm **10** also subdues any tension or resistance the fish may feel, so the fish holds onto the bait longer. Furthermore, the yoke **31** is operatively coupled to the electronic alarm **27**, wherein the yoke **31** is used to activate the electronic alarm **27**. For example, the yoke **31** can be connected to the electronic alarm **27** using a physical connector, such as a magnetic or mechanical switch, that allows the electronic alarm **27** to be activated when the yoke **31** is engaged to the electronic alarm **27**. Once the yoke **31** moves and the physical connector is disengaged, the electronic alarm **27** is activated to emit a loud alert that the user can hear from a distance. In other embodiments, different connectors can be implemented that allow the automatic activation of the electronic alarm **27** when a fish has been caught.

(26) In the preferred embodiment, the present invention can be deployed as follows: the holder base **1** is arranged into the rod-holding configuration so that the desired fishing rod can be attached to the rod-holding assembly **13**, as can be seen in FIGS. **1** through **4**. The butt portion is positioned on the grip brace **16**, and the handle portion is attached to the grip holder **14**. Once the desired fishing rod is attached to the rod-holding assembly **13**, the user can move the indicator flag closer to the desired fishing rod by moving the sail shaft **18** against the flexible arm **10**. This allows the electronic alarm **27** and the trigger mechanism **28** to be arranged in an alarm-primed configuration

by linking the hook **29** to the catch **30**. This also allows the yoke **31** to engage with the electronic alarm **27** to prime the electronic alarm **27**. Once primed, the user can deploy the fishing line to the water along with the lure, and the fishing line can also be engaged with the yoke **31**. This way, the present invention is ready to attract fish once securely placed on the ground next to the water.

(27) Once the fish bites the lure and starts pulling on the fishing line, the electronic alarm **27** and the indicator sail **21** are triggered to alert the user that a fish has been caught. As can be seen in FIGS. **1** through **4**, in an alarm-activated configuration, the hook **29** is released from the catch **30** which positions the hook **29** offset from the catch **30** due to the fishing line pulling on the yoke **31**. The fishing line moves the yoke **31** away from the electronic alarm **27** to trigger the electronic alarm **27**. Simultaneously, the hook **29** is rotated away from the catch **30**, which in turn releases the sail shaft **18** and allows the indicator sail **21** to move and alert the user visually that a fish has been caught. Since the sail shaft **18** is connected to the flexible arm **10** via the spring-loaded shaft end **19**, the indicator sail **21** keeps moving in a rocking motion which, along with the sound alert from the electronic alarm **27**, help attract the user's attention so that the user can promptly come and retrieve the caught fish.

(28) The catch **30** is preferably designed so that the catch **30** can move along the sail shaft **18** as the present invention is arranged into the different configurations as desired by the user. To enable so, the catch **30** has a tab-like structure with a shaft hole, a hook hole, and an intermediate hole. The shaft hole is preferable centered on the catch **30** with a size large enough to accommodate the sail shaft **18** that allows the catch **30** to slide along the sail shaft **18**. Further, the hook hole is an opening large enough to receive the hook **29** when the trigger mechanism **28** and the electronic alarm **27** are in the alarm-activated configuration. The hook hole is large enough that enables the hook **29** to engage the catch **30** when the sail shaft **18** is bent towards the flexible arm **10** in the alarm-activated configuration. Due to the arrangement of the sail shaft **18** and the flexible arm **10**, the hook **29** may not perfectly align with the hook hole, so the hook hole needs to be large enough to allow the hook **29** to engage with the catch **30** at an angle. A rubber plug may be included to ensure the releasable engagement of the hook **29** with the hook hole without risk of the hook **29** from accidentally disengaging due to movements of the sail shaft **18** and/or the flexible arm **10**. Furthermore, the intermediate hole is positioned between the shaft hole and the hook hole to receive the hook **29** when the present invention is arranged into the storage configuration. The intermediate hole is a hole large enough to receive the hook **29** in the storage configuration to position the sail shaft **18** against the collapsed flexible arm **10**. This prevents the sail shaft **18** and the indicator sail **21** from getting tangled with other equipment when the present invention is being stored away or transported with other fishing equipment.

(29) Although the invention has been explained in relation to its preferred embodiment, it is to be understood that many other possible modifications and variations can be made without departing from the spirit and scope of the invention.

Claims

1. A multifunctional fishing rod holder comprising: a holder base; a flexible arm; a rod-holding assembly; a sail shaft; an indicator sail; the holder base comprising a 4-way tee fitting, a static leg, a first dynamic leg, and a second dynamic leg; the flexible arm comprising a proximal arm end and a distal arm end; the sail shaft comprising a spring-loaded shaft end and a free shaft end; the rod-holding assembly being mounted onto the distal arm end; the 4-way tee fitting being mounted onto the proximal arm end; the flexible arm, the static leg, and the first dynamic leg being orthogonally mounted to each other by the 4-way tee fitting; the flexible arm, the static leg, and the second dynamic leg being orthogonally mounted to each other by the 4-way tee fitting; the spring-loaded shaft end being laterally connected to the flexible arm, offset from the rod-holding assembly; the sail shaft being oriented away from the static leg; and the indicator sail being mounted onto the free

shaft end.

2. The multifunctional fishing rod holder as claimed in claim 1 further comprising: the 4-way tee fitting comprising a first C-shaped socket, a second C-shaped socket, a third C-shaped socket, and a round socket; the round socket, the first C-shaped socket, and the second C-shaped socket being positioned coplanar to each other; the first C-shaped socket and the second C-shaped socket being positioned opposite to each other about the 4-way tee fitting; the first C-shaped socket and the second C-shaped socket being positioned perpendicular to the round socket; the third C-shaped socket being oriented normal to the round socket, the first C-shaped socket, and the second C-shaped socket; the static leg being mounted into the round socket; the first dynamic leg being hingedly connected into the first C-shaped socket; the second dynamic leg being hingedly connected into the second C-shaped socket; and the flexible arm being hingedly connected into the third C-shaped socket.

3. The multifunctional fishing rod holder as claimed in claim 2 further comprising: wherein the flexible arm, the static leg, the first dynamic leg, and the second dynamic leg are arranged into a rod-holding configuration; a locking sleeve; the first dynamic leg and the second dynamic leg being positioned perpendicular to the static leg; the first dynamic leg and the second dynamic leg being positioned colinear to each other; the flexible arm being oriented normal to the static leg, the first dynamic leg, and the second dynamic leg; and the locking sleeve being laterally positioned around the hinged connection between the flexible arm and the third C-shaped socket.

4. The multifunctional fishing rod holder as claimed in claim 2 further comprising: wherein the flexible arm, the static leg, the first dynamic leg, and the second dynamic leg are arranged into a storage configuration; and the first dynamic leg, the second dynamic leg, and the flexible arm being positioned parallel to the static leg.

5. The multifunctional fishing rod holder as claimed in claim 1 further comprising: a plurality of stakes; the plurality of stakes being connected onto the holder base; and each of the plurality of stakes being oriented away from the flexible arm.

6. The multifunctional fishing rod holder as claimed in claim 5 further comprising: the plurality of stakes comprising a first stake, a second stake, and a third stake; the first stake being laterally connected to the first dynamic leg, offset from the 4-way tee fitting; the second stake being laterally connected to the second dynamic leg, offset from the 4-way tee fitting; and the third stake being laterally connected to the static leg, offset from the 4-way tee fitting.

7. The multifunctional fishing rod holder as claimed in claim 1 further comprising: the rod-holding assembly comprising a grip holder and a grip brace; the grip holder comprising a gripping surface; the grip brace comprising a bracing surface; the grip holder and the grip brace being laterally connected to the flexible arm; the grip holder and the grip brace being positioned collinear to each other along the flexible arm; the grip holder and the grip brace being oriented towards the static leg; the grip holder being positioned in between the distal arm end and the grip brace; and the gripping surface and the bracing surface being positioned parallel to each other.

8. The multifunctional fishing rod holder as claimed in claim 1 further comprising: an electronic alarm; a trigger mechanism; the trigger mechanism comprising a hook, a catch, a yoke, a setting, and an axle; the setting and the electronic alarm being laterally mounted to the flexible arm, adjacent to the distal arm end; the hook being terminally connected to the axle; the yoke being terminally connected to the axle, opposite to the hook; the axle being rotatably mounted through the setting; the catch being laterally mounted to the sail shaft, offset from the free shaft end; and the yoke being operatively coupled to the electronic alarm, wherein the yoke is used to activate the electronic alarm.

9. The multifunctional fishing rod holder as claimed in claim 8 further comprising: wherein the electronic alarm and the trigger mechanism are arranged in an alarm-primed configuration; and the hook being linked to the catch.

10. The multifunctional fishing rod holder as claimed in claim 8 further comprising: wherein the

electronic alarm and the trigger mechanism are arranged in an alarm-activated configuration; and the hook being positioned offset from the catch.

11. The multifunctional fishing rod holder as claimed in claim 1, wherein the flexible arm is a tempered spring steel strap.

12. A multifunctional fishing rod holder comprising: a holder base; a flexible arm; a rod-holding assembly; a sail shaft; an indicator sail; a plurality of stakes; the flexible arm being a tempered spring steel strap; the holder base comprising a 4-way tee fitting, a static leg, a first dynamic leg, and a second dynamic leg; the flexible arm comprising a proximal arm end and a distal arm end; the sail shaft comprising a spring-loaded shaft end and a free shaft end; the rod-holding assembly being mounted onto the distal arm end; the 4-way tee fitting being mounted onto the proximal arm end; the flexible arm, the static leg, and the first dynamic leg being orthogonally mounted to each other by the 4-way tee fitting; the flexible arm, the static leg, and the second dynamic leg being orthogonally mounted to each other by the 4-way tee fitting; the spring-loaded shaft end being laterally connected to the flexible arm, offset from the rod-holding assembly; the sail shaft being oriented away from the static leg; the indicator sail being mounted onto the free shaft end; the plurality of stakes being connected onto the holder base; and each of the plurality of stakes being oriented away from the flexible arm.

13. The multifunctional fishing rod holder as claimed in claim 12 further comprising: the 4-way tee fitting comprising a first C-shaped socket, a second C-shaped socket, a third C-shaped socket, and a round socket; the round socket, the first C-shaped socket, and the second C-shaped socket being positioned coplanar to each other; the first C-shaped socket and the second C-shaped socket being positioned opposite to each other about the 4-way tee fitting; the first C-shaped socket and the second C-shaped socket being positioned perpendicular to the round socket; the third C-shaped socket being oriented normal to the round socket, the first C-shaped socket, and the second C-shaped socket; the static leg being mounted into the round socket; the first dynamic leg being hingedly connected into the first C-shaped socket; the second dynamic leg being hingedly connected into the second C-shaped socket; and the flexible arm being hingedly connected into the third C-shaped socket.

14. The multifunctional fishing rod holder as claimed in claim 13 further comprising: wherein the flexible arm, the static leg, the first dynamic leg, and the second dynamic leg are arranged into a rod-holding configuration; a locking sleeve; the first dynamic leg and the second dynamic leg being positioned perpendicular to the static leg; the first dynamic leg and the second dynamic leg being positioned colinear to each other; the flexible arm being oriented normal to the static leg, the first dynamic leg, and the second dynamic leg; and the locking sleeve being laterally positioned around the hinged connection between the flexible arm and the third C-shaped socket.

15. The multifunctional fishing rod holder as claimed in claim 13 further comprising: wherein the flexible arm, the static leg, the first dynamic leg, and the second dynamic leg are arranged into a storage configuration; and the first dynamic leg, the second dynamic leg, and the flexible arm being positioned parallel to the static leg.

16. The multifunctional fishing rod holder as claimed in claim 12 further comprising: the plurality of stakes comprising a first stake, a second stake, and a third stake; the first stake being laterally connected to the first dynamic leg, offset from the 4-way tee fitting; the second stake being laterally connected to the second dynamic leg, offset from the 4-way tee fitting; and the third stake being laterally connected to the static leg, offset from the 4-way tee fitting.

17. The multifunctional fishing rod holder as claimed in claim 12 further comprising: the rod-holding assembly comprising a grip holder and a grip brace; the grip holder comprising a gripping surface; the grip brace comprising a bracing surface; the grip holder and the grip brace being laterally connected to the flexible arm; the grip holder and the grip brace being positioned collinear to each other along the flexible arm; the grip holder and the grip brace being oriented towards the static leg; the grip holder being positioned in between the distal arm end and the grip brace; and the

gripping surface and the bracing surface being positioned parallel to each other.

18. The multifunctional fishing rod holder as claimed in claim 12 further comprising: an electronic alarm; a trigger mechanism; the trigger mechanism comprising a hook, a catch, a yoke, a setting, and an axle; the setting and the electronic alarm being laterally mounted to the flexible arm, adjacent to the distal arm end; the hook being terminally connected to the axle; the yoke being terminally connected to the axle, opposite to the hook; the axle being rotatably mounted through the setting; the catch being laterally mounted to the sail shaft, offset from the free shaft end; and the yoke being operatively coupled to the electronic alarm, wherein the yoke is used to activate the electronic alarm.

19. The multifunctional fishing rod holder as claimed in claim 18 further comprising: wherein the electronic alarm and the trigger mechanism are arranged in an alarm-primed configuration; and the hook being linked to the catch.

20. The multifunctional fishing rod holder as claimed in claim 18 further comprising: wherein the electronic alarm and the trigger mechanism are arranged in an alarm-activated configuration; and the hook being positioned offset from the catch.
